



INSTITUTE FOR CHRISTIAN STUDIES

Annual Convocation

2026

for the conferral of degrees upon

Junior Members

and the conferral of

Doctor of Letters, honoris causa

upon

John A. Olthuis

with an inaugural address by

Dr. Neal DeRoo

Friday, May 29, 2026

6:30 pm · Knox College · Toronto, Ontario

ORDER OF SERVICE

PROCESSIONAL HYMN

All stand

“Be Thou My Vision”

Traditional Irish • Tune: SLANE

*Be Thou my vision, O Lord of my heart;
Naught be all else to me, save that Thou art;
Thou my best thought, by day or by night;
Waking or sleeping, Thy presence my light.*

*Be Thou my wisdom, and Thou my true Word;
I ever with Thee and Thou with me, Lord;
Thou my great Father and I, Thy true son;
Thou in me dwelling, and I with Thee one.*

*Riches I heed not, nor man's empty praise;
Thou mine inheritance, now and always;
Thou and Thou only, first in my heart;
O King of glory, my treasure Thou art.*

*High King of Heaven, when victory is won;
May I reach Heaven's joys, bright Heaven's sun;
Heart of my own heart, whatever befall;
Still be my vision, O Ruler of all.*

WELCOME

Please be seated

Ronald A. Kuipers, President

OPENING PRAYER

Dan Beerens, Chair of the Board of Trustees

FIRST SCRIPTURE READING

Stacy Kok, Graduand, MWS in Education

Amos 5:18–24

SECOND SCRIPTURE READING

Kevin Otter, Graduand, MA in Educational Leadership

Colossians 2:6–10

ORDER OF SERVICE, CONTINUED

MUSICAL INTERLUDE I

Remain seated

Cantique de Jean Racine

Gabriel Fauré

CITATION

Ronald A. Kuipers, *President*

for John A. Olthuis

THE CONFERRING OF HONOURARY DEGREE

Joshua Harris, *Chancellor*

Ronald A. Kuipers, *President*

Dan Beerens, *Chair of the Board of Trustees*

Edith van der Boom, *Interim Academic Dean*

DOCTOR OF LETTERS (HONORIS CAUSA)

John A. Olthuis

REFLECTION ON HONOURARY DEGREE

John A. Olthuis, *Doctor of Letters (honoris causa)*

CONVOCATION ADDRESS

“Philosophy for a World in Crisis”

Dr. Neal DeRoo, *Senior Member & Director of the MA/PhD Programs*

MUSICAL INTERLUDE II

Remain seated

“Great is Thy Faithfulness”

Dan Forrest

THE CONFERRING OF DEGREES

Joshua Harris, *Chancellor*

Ronald A. Kuipers, *President*

Dan Beerens, *Chair of the Board of Trustees*

Edith van der Boom, *Interim Academic Dean*

MASTER OF WORLDVIEW STUDIES

Julia Cherian * *Presented by Edith van der Boom*

Stacy Kok *Presented by Edith van der Boom*

ORDER OF SERVICE, CONTINUED

MASTER OF ARTS (PHILOSOPHY)

Heidi Blokland Presented by Edith van der Boom
Project: Mind the Gap, Please

Kevin Otter^{**} Presented by Edith van der Boom
Project: Unsettling Stories: A Christian Settler Educator's Journey from Mistakes to Responsibility in Indigenous Education

* Degree conferred *in absentia* ** Dean's Award recipient

COMMISSIONING OF GRADUATES

Joshua Harris, Chancellor & Chair of Senate

CLOSING PRAYER

Please stand

Heidi Blokland, Graduand, MA in Educational Leadership

RECESSIONAL HYMN

Remain standing

"Canticle of the Turning"

Rory Cooney • Tune: STAR OF THE COUNTY DOWN

*My soul cries out with a joyful shout
that the God of my heart is great,
And my spirit sings of the wondrous things
that you bring to the ones who wait.
You fixed your sight on your servant's plight,
and my weakness you did not spurn,
So from east to west shall my name be blest.
Could the world be about to turn?*

REFRAIN

*My heart shall sing of the day you bring.
Let the fires of your justice burn.
Wipe away all tears, for the dawn draws near,
and the world is about to turn!*

*Though I am small, my God, my all,
you work great things in me,
And your mercy will last from the depths of the past
to the end of the age to be.
Your very name puts the proud to shame,
and to those who would for you yearn,
You will show your might, put the strong to flight,
for the world is about to turn.*

My heart shall sing...

*From the halls of power to the fortress tower,
not a stone will be left on stone.
Let the king beware for your justice tears
ev'ry tyrant from his throne.
The hungry poor shall weep no more,
for the food they can never earn;
There are tables spread, ev'ry mouth be fed,
for the world is about to turn.*

My heart shall sing...

*Though the nations rage from age to age,
we remember who holds us fast:
God's mercy must deliver us
from the conqueror's crushing grasp.
This saving word that our forebears heard
is the promise which holds us bound,
'Til the spear and rod can be crushed by God,
who is turning the world around.*

My heart shall sing...

HONOURARY DOCTORATE

Doctor of Letters

honoris causa

John A. Olthuis

Lawyer, social justice advocate, and institution-builder. From his role as the founding Executive Director of the Association for the Advancement of Christian Scholarship in 1967 to more than five decades of landmark Aboriginal-law practice, John's life is an eloquent demonstration of what the integration of faith, scholarship, and public life looks like.

ACADEMIC PROCESSION

DAIS PARTY

Dr. Ronald A. Kuipers
President

Dr. Joshua Lee Harris
Chancellor & Chair of Senate

Mr. Dan Beerens
Chair of the Board of Trustees

Dr. Edith van der Boom
Interim Academic Dean

ICS SENIOR MEMBERS

Dr. Nik Ansell

Dr. Neal DeRoo

Dr. Gideon Strauss

ICS SENIOR MEMBERS EMERITI

Dr. James Olthuis

Dr. Robert Sweetman

Dr. Rebekah Smick

ICS EXTERNAL SENATORS

Dr. Pamela Beattie
*Associate Professor of Medieval Studies,
University of Louisville*

Dr. Steven Bouma-Prediger
Professor of Religion, Hope College

Dr. Margie Patrick
*Associate Professor of Education, The King's
University*

Dr. Janet Wesselius
Professor of Philosophy, University of Alberta

DISTINGUISHED GUESTS

Dr. Beth Green
Incoming President

Dr. Sylvia Keesmaat
Former Senior Member

Dr. Michael Krause
*Associate Professor of Leadership and
Ministry, Tyndale Seminary*

Dr. J. Richard Middleton
*Professor Emeritus, Roberts Wesleyan
University*

Dr. Brian Walsh
Former Senior Member

Everyone is welcome to join us for a reception immediately following the ceremony in the **Knox College rotunda**. The building will close at 9:30 pm.

Graduates and the Platform Party will assemble at the front of the Sanctuary immediately following the Recessional for photos. Please allow the ICS photographer to take photos first and wait for direction.



Institute for Christian Studies

ICS SENIOR MEMBERS

Nik Ansell

MPhil (ICS), PhD (VUA)

Neal DeRoo

MA (ICS), PhD (Boston College)

Ronald A. Kuipers

MPhil (ICS), PhD (VUA)

Gideon Strauss

MA & PhD (Universiteit van die Vrystaat)

Edith van der Boom

MEd (Brock University), PhD (UofT)

MUSICIANS

Kai Leung

Music Director & Bass

Nicholas Wanstall

Pianist

Emily Parker

Soprano

Peter Koniers

Alto

Nathan Gritter

Tenor

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